INDIA TODAY
INDO-JAPAN
CONCLAVE
2023



ENERGY

THE GREEN HYDROGEN BOOM

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THE CLEAN POWER PUSH

As India aims to produce 5 million tonnes of green hydrogen annually by 2030, experts discuss the opportunities and the challenges

GOING GREEN FROM GREY

Derek M. Shah: India already generates grey hydrogen to the extent of about 5 to 6 million [tonnes annually]. And by 2030, it will be about 12 million. So in our efforts to decarbonise, we would like to reduce the dependence on grey and go to green hydrogen by at least 5 million times. A large part of it is achievable given the trust the government is giving, the corporates are giving.... L&T realised long back that there was going to be a shift away from fossil fuels. So we focused on the green energy sector, and we have laid out a plan to capture the entire value chain across green hydrogen. Therefore, L&T is looking at manufacturing electrolysers. A large part of our green hydrogen commitment is also directed towards exports of green hydrogen, and Japan plays a very, very important role in this entire commitment.

THE DE-RISKING IMPERATIVE

Ramnath Vaidyanathan: The Dow Jones Sustainability Index measures the performance of the ESG (environmental, social and governance)-focused companies on their stock price performance versus the regular index. Over the last 15 years, the companies which have been strong on ESG have outperformed the index continuously, and the gap is growing. Being strong on ESG is basically de-risking...yourself for the future, which is very uncertain when it comes to climate. In India, at least, clean energy is one of the cheapest ways to really decarbonise because renewable energy in India is fundamentally cheap.

SUSTAINABLE GROWTH

Rita Roy Choudhury: What is imperative is that the entire ecosystem develops in a holistic manner so that, as we ramp up